

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting August 3rd, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 3, 2026

Type: Regular Commissioners Meeting

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Reagan called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting of August 3, 2026, to order at [00:09:03](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Brown, Commissioner Reagan, Mr. Brooks, and Mr. Ruble (County Attorney Fred Ruble).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Reagan.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:09:12](#).

- **Citizen Recognitions:** [00:09:46](#) Tonya Dunsmore (Delaware County Auditor's Chief Deputy) presented the "Team Employees of the Month" award to Whitney Brewer (Whitney Trent) and Elizabeth Smalley from the Auditor's office for their exceptional work managing the county budget, tax settlement, and state reporting.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Executive Session minutes from July 16 (1:00 PM and 2:00 PM) and July 28 (2:00 PM): Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:18:54 / 00:19:31] (Commissioner Henry abstained on the July 28 minutes).
 - Regular meeting minutes from July 20: Tabled by Roll Call Vote [00:19:06](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:14:12](#) **Civic Center Authority Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Discussion.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board noted an upcoming vacancy for a Democratic representative on the Civic Center Authority board to complete a term running through July 21, 2028. Names must be submitted by the August 17 meeting ahead of the board's August 20 meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote; item left for board consideration.
- [00:19:42](#) **Opioid Settlement Fund Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble / Board Discussion.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding restricted (\$42,387.49) and unrestricted (\$4,654.66) August 2026 opioid settlement distributions. A prior spending plan from March will be recirculated to commissioners and legal counsel for review under old business.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Placed on the agenda under old business.
- [00:22:32](#) **Delaware County Soil and Water Conservation District Funding Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Claire Burt & Colby Gray.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updates on invasive species removal (DIP), upcoming 2027 DNR LAIR funding (\$35,000 for watershed best practices), stormwater-matched technical assistance grants, GIS technician mapping, and the White River branding project. The board discussed past funding levels (\$25,000) and noted that GIS work could potentially be layered onto public Beacon maps.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for more information by Roll Call Vote [00:30:41](#).
- [00:31:02](#) **Human Resources: Medical Premiums Upon Separation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal (Human Resources).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed an inconsistency where employees separating in the first pay cycle of a month were receiving end-of-month health coverage without paying the full month's premium deduction. The board agreed to enforce plan rules immediately via a handbook amendment.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved request with a handbook amendment scheduled for August 17 by Roll Call Vote [00:34:06](#).
- **00:34:16 Medical, Dental, and Vision Benefits Split (2027)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Royal.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following the previous unbundling of medical, dental, and vision benefits, the board evaluated options for 2027. Option 2 maintains commitments not to raise employee premium shares, backed by anticipated savings (\$1.1 million) from switching benefit providers to Marsh McLennan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Option 2 approved by Roll Call Vote [00:36:06](#).
- **00:36:23 Cummins / Aurelian AI Non-Emergency Call Answering Service Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cummins / Fred Ruble.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested approval for a 3-year contract (\$85,000/year) with Aurelian, an AI non-emergency call answering service integrated with dispatch CAD systems, funded via the statewide 911 fund. Legal counsel reviewed terms regarding automatic renewal, indemnification, and governing law (Washington vs. Indiana).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved pending legal review and successful negotiation by Roll Call Vote [00:44:36](#).
- **00:44:49 County Building Chiller Compressor Replacement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board on behalf of Maintenance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for Chiller #2, System 1 compressor replacement totaling \$39,735, to be funded from EDIT Capital Projects Fund 12. Commissioners requested future bids clearly break down labor and parts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:47:09](#).
- **00:47:14 County Building Boiler Replacement Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Discussion.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initial estimate of \$124,430 for replacing the failing primary boiler. Because costs are under \$150,000, competitive quotes will be solicited with a detailed scope of work.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote; for public deliberation.
- **00:48:27 Muncie Recovery Lease Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble / Board Discussion.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Modified insurance requirements for Muncie Recovery (removing liquor liability risk due to no alcohol) and increased the base lease rate from \$17.00 to \$18.50 per square foot per year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:50:23](#).
- **00:50:36 INDOT Coordination Contract: Bridge 509 (PE Phase)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thompson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** INDOT coordination contract for Bridge 509 preliminary engineering phase, wherein INDOT covers 80% (\$544,000) of the \$680,000 project. Local matching funds are budgeted.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:51:19](#).
- [00:51:30](#) **State Road 28 and I-69 Interchange Study Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thompson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed \$121,000 feasibility and traffic/infrastructure study with Lochmueller for the State Road 28 and I-69 interchange to support commercial and industrial economic development. Funded from EDIT Project 4.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:54:04](#).
- [00:54:11](#) **Ordinance 2026-11: Adjustment of Pay Periods for 2027**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduced an ordinance to shift county pay periods starting in 2027 from bi-weekly (26-27 pays/year) to twice a month on the 15th and last day of the month (fixed 24 pays/year).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call Vote [00:56:28](#).
- [00:36:36](#) **Ordinance 2026-12: Amending County Code Regulating Public Roadway Activities & Permits**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble / Engineering Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Revised ordinance focusing strictly on roadway use permits and bonds for utility/excavation work, removing right-of-way provisions unrelated to physical road conditions. Formatting minor text wrap errors noted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call Vote [00:59:16](#).
- [00:59:24](#) **Ordinance 2026-13: Traffic Regulations, Stop Intersections, and Speed Limits**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Engineering & Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes multiple new all-way stop intersections (including Walnut Street & Fuson Road, citing 22 wrecks over 5 years) and speed limits across various county roads and townships. Public hearing scheduled for August 17.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call Vote [01:03:32](#).
- [01:04:03](#) **Ordinance 2026-14: Vacation of Plat, Alleys, and Second Street (Mount Summit)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Follow-up to a prior public hearing to vacate old platted alleys and Second Street in Mount Summit with no public objections raised.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call Vote [01:05:04](#).
- [01:05:14](#) **Ordinance 2026-15: Amending Chapter 3 Regarding Grass and Weeds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Ruble.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updates the county weed/mowing ordinance (last amended in 2008), setting penalty notices at \$150 and \$500, with enforcement powers granted to the health department, building commissioner, sheriff, or designee. Health department feedback will be integrated.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by Roll Call Vote [01:07:04](#).

- **01:14:09 Liability Insurance RFP Issuance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Brooke Struble.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to issue an RFP for county liability insurance to allow local and regional brokers to bid.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:14:45](#).
- **01:23:05 Mowing RFP Bid Opening**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Opened four submitted bids for the on-call mowing RFP (trash removal, weed control, mowing):
 1. Smith Family Services (West Jackson Street, Muncie)
 2. All Seasons Landscaping (Hoyt Avenue, Muncie)
 3. Bailey's Landscape and Excavation (County Road 300 East, Muncie)
 4. A&S Roofing Services (Hackley Street, Muncie — noted as non-mowing/misfiled bid).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Bids taken under advisement to be compiled into a spreadsheet for review by Roll Call Vote [01:27:04](#).
- **01:34:16 Claims, Credit Cards, Payroll, and Financial Approvals**
 - **Payment of Claims:** \$3,311,466.77 (including TIF bond payments, Vialytics road rating system software, and utility claims) — Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:33:59](#).
 - **Credit Card Claims (Thrive/DCCC):** \$301.70 — Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:35:39](#).
 - **Computer Solutions (ARC):** \$4,325.00 — Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:35:58](#).
 - **Payroll (July 29):** \$1,069,883.16 — Approved by Roll Call Vote [01:36:16](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:38:44 Ricky Green (Newsman and Author):** Commended the board for providing ordinance copies to the public, but cautioned against rushing into AI contracts for 911 dispatching with unproven startups like Aurelian. He also noted property speculation around the I-69/SR 28 corridor and referenced ongoing public records compliance issues in Muncie.
- **01:39:54 Chad Thornburg (Represented by Legal Counsel):** Addressed a 13-year property line dispute along a quarter section line on Clifton Road, asking the county to take responsibility and have the county surveyor mark official quarter-section lines.
 - *Board Action:* Commissioner Reagan moved to hire outside legal counsel (Mick Cockrell from Randolph County) to review the county's responsibilities regarding the survey line dispute; seconded and approved by Roll Call Vote [[01:33:51](#) (approx)].
- **01:44:16 Breedlove Faulkner:** Inquired about ADA compliance formatting on agendas, specifically noting a missing date on a speaking portion heading.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **IT (Ryan Stoltz):** Provided updates on the failing internet failover project (leveraging Comcast/AT&T LTE appliances), Cisco power supplies, building blueprints via iPads, wireless access point completions, and a new on-premise IT/maintenance help desk ticket software. Microsoft 365 migration planning is underway.
 - **Treasurer (Brad Holt):** Requested a special meeting of the Board of Finance to formally vote on interest allocations for Community Corrections and the Drainage Board, scheduled as a 4:45 AM/PM special meeting ahead of the August 17 meeting.
 - **Commissioner Brand:**
 - Reported successful temporary roof leak mitigations at the Justice Center and noted a forthcoming roof RFP for August 17.
 - Noted receipt of \$459,009.99 in CCMG lane-mile direct distribution funds, proposing to hold and save the funds for 2027 matching requirements.
 - Highlighted cybersecurity “KnowBe4” training compliance (currently at 83%) and warned that non-compliant users will lose system access.
 - Noted ECI tipping fee cleanup costs for Hyde Park totaled \$146.10.
 - Announced the Municipal Unit Strategic Task Force (MUST) public meeting for August 18 at 4:00 PM.
 - Noted state legislative committee hearings regarding designating a memorial mile on I-69 for fallen Corporal Blake Reynolds.
 - Discussed internal training successes (Maintenance Superintendent Don Chambers earning an Ivy Tech PLC certification, saving on high service call fees).
 - Noted a fairgrounds injury claim (\$1,200 bill from April) under review alongside risk management insurance policies.
 - **Commissioner Henry:**
 - Paid tribute to the late Lynn Town Marshal Brad Fisher, thanking local emergency responders for participating in his escort and funeral honors.
 - Announced the Veterans Stand Down event at Heartland Hall on September 15 (10:00 AM – 2:00 PM).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting recessed/adjourned following a motion to recess [02:02:07](#).